



Peanut

Native American plants

These include cocoa (for chocolate), sunflowers (to give us oil to cook with), and peanuts.



Pineapples were one of the new fruits found by the explorers. They were given this name because they looked like pine cones.

Black beans



Avocados look like pears with rough, tough skins. They were first grown in Central America.



Healing plants

When the explorers reached the Americas, they found skilled healers among the people living there. These healers used thousands of plants to make medicines. Their remedies were used to cure many illnesses, including stomach pains, headaches, coughs, and fevers. Many of these plants are still used today to make medicines.

Cinchona leaf



Cinchona bark

Quinine tablets

Quinine is used to prevent an illness called malaria. It is made from the bark of the cinchona tree.

Lots of different beans came from Mexico. These are red beans.

These small, hot peppers are chillies. They were used to flavor the bowls of corn porridge that the Mexicans ate for breakfast.

Sweet potatoes

Tomatoes, first grown in South America, spread to Mexico, where the Spanish came across them. The first ones they brought to Europe were small and yellow.

Potatoes were first grown in the Andes Mountains. They were loaded aboard the treasure ships as food for the sailors.

